

S E M A R G I

Feminizing Makeup After 45

5 fixes the tutorials never show — because they were
filmed on a 22-year-old.

PRIVATE ONLINE SESSIONS · US & CANADA



It was never made for your face

Almost every feminizing makeup tutorial online is made on young, smooth skin with no facial hair shadow, no hooded lids and no jaw to soften. You copy it step by step and it doesn't work — not because you did it wrong, but because it was never made for your face.



These are the five corrections our stylists make most often in private sessions with women starting or refining makeup after 45. Each one takes a page. Each one you can try tonight with what you already own.

— *Semargi*

INSIDE

1. Foundation looks cakey by noon
2. Facial hair shadow shows through no matter how much you pile on
3. Eyeliner disappears the moment you open your eyes
4. Brows look drawn on, or too heavy
5. Contour makes the jaw look dirty, not softer

Foundation looks cakey by noon

THE USUAL ADVICE

One full pump of foundation, buffed in with a dense brush, then powder everywhere.

WHY IT FAILS AFTER 45

Mature skin has fine lines, larger pores and a drier surface. A thick layer doesn't sit *on* the skin — it settles *into* every line and cracks as you talk and smile. Powder on top locks the cracks in place.

The fix: prime, then build in thin layers

- 1 Moisturize, wait 2–3 minutes, then a gripping or putty primer (e.g. e.l.f. Power Grip or e.l.f. Putty Primer, \$10–12 at any drugstore).**
Fills lines and pores, gives foundation something to hold on to — this alone changes wear time.
- 2 Use about a third of what you think you need. Dot it on the centre of the face only.**
You can always add. You can't take away a thick layer without starting over.
- 3 Blend outward with a damp sponge, pressing rather than sweeping.**
A sponge presses product thin and gives the softest finish. A brush is useful when you want to build more coverage in one spot — it deposits more product — but on mature skin it can drag into lines, so use it deliberately, not as your default.
- 4 Where you still see something — the facial hair area, redness — add a *second thin layer* there only.**
Coverage where you need it, skin everywhere else.
- 5 Powder only the T-zone, with a light hand. Then a setting spray all over.**
Spray melts powder into the base so it stops looking like a layer.

Try tonight Do your usual routine on one side of the face, this method on the other. Look at both at the 4-hour mark.

Facial hair shadow shows through no matter how much you pile on

THE USUAL ADVICE

Full-coverage foundation, then more foundation, then concealer.

WHY IT FAILS AFTER 45

Facial hair shadow is blue-grey. Beige foundation on top of blue-grey turns muddy; adding more just makes it muddy *and* thick. This is a colour problem, not a coverage problem.

The fix: cancel the colour first, then cover lightly

1

Shave as close as you comfortably can, then moisturize and prime (Fix 1).

Stubble texture reads as shadow even when the colour is covered.

2

Pick a corrector opposite to blue-grey on the colour wheel: peach for fair skin, orange for medium, red-orange for deep skin.

Opposite colours cancel each other out.

3

Apply a thin layer only over the shadow — upper lip, chin, along the jaw. Press it in with a damp sponge; do not rub.

Rubbing moves it off. Pressing sets it, and a sponge gives a more even, skin-like finish than fingers.

4

Foundation on top, thin (Fix 1). The corrector does the work; the foundation just evens the tone.

You'll use less foundation than before and see less shadow.

5

Set that area with a small amount of powder. Setting spray to finish.

Corrector + foundation is two layers in one place; set it so it stays.

Common mistake Using a corrector that's too pale (a pink "brightening" concealer) — it turns the area grey. If the result looks ashy, go warmer.

Eyeliner disappears the moment you open your eyes

THE USUAL ADVICE

A neat wing drawn along the lash line with the eye closed.

WHY IT FAILS AFTER 45

On hooded or deep-set eyes, with the eye open the lid skin folds over the line. Everything you drew is hidden under the hood — and it transfers onto the upper lid as a smudge.

The fix: draw with the eye open, place the line where it will be seen

1

Eyeshadow primer or a thin layer of concealer on the lid, set with a skin-tone powder.

Stops transfer and evens the darkness many of us have on the lid.

2

Look straight into the mirror with the eye *open*, chin slightly down.

You need to see where the visible lid actually is on your face.

3

Tightline: run a dark pencil along the upper waterline, right between the lashes.

Thickens the lash base with zero visible line — nothing to hide under the hood.

4

If you want a wing: mark the tip first, with the eye open, then connect it to the outer third of the lash line. Keep it short and slightly upward.

A wing that follows the fold instead of fighting it stays visible.

5

Curl lashes, then mascara — top lashes only, wiggle at the base.

Curled lashes lift the whole eye more than any liner.

Product note Use a waterproof or long-wear gel liner for the wing; ordinary liquid liner is what transfers.

Brows look drawn on, or too heavy

THE USUAL ADVICE

A sharp, filled-in “Instagram brow” with a hard outline.

WHY IT FAILS AFTER 45

After 45 the hair is often coarse and sparse at the same time; the brow sits low and heavy. A hard outline makes it look pasted on and drags the eye down — the opposite of feminizing.

The fix: lift the arch, soften the head, hair-strokes not a block

1

Brush the hairs up and slightly out with a spoolie. Trim only what sticks out well above the shape.

Brushing up instantly raises the brow without removing anything.

2

Use a fine pencil (e.g. a micro-tip brow pencil) one shade *lighter* than your hair. Draw tiny upward strokes only where there are gaps, mostly in the arch and tail.

Lighter reads softer; strokes read as hair.

3

Leave the head of the brow (near the nose) almost bare — a few strokes, no outline.

A softer, less defined head makes the whole brow read as more feminine; a dark squared-off edge is what makes it look drawn on.

4

Set the hairs upward with a clear or tinted brow gel.

Holds the lift all day; tames coarse hairs.

5

A touch of concealer just under the arch, blended.

Sharpens the arch and lifts the eye without any brow makeup being visible.

Contour makes the jaw look dirty, not softer

THE USUAL ADVICE

A dark stripe under the cheekbone and along the whole jawline, blended into a shadow.

WHY IT FAILS AFTER 45

On a wider or squarer jaw, a stripe along the jaw *outlines* it — it makes the shape more visible, not less. Too-warm bronzer looks orange; too-cool grey looks like dirt.

The fix: shadow the corners, light the centre

1

Choose a cream contour one to two shades deeper than your skin, with a neutral-to-cool undertone (not bronzer).

A shadow is cooler than the skin; bronzer is warmer and reads as a tan, not a shape.

2

Place a small amount only on the *corners* of the jaw (under the ear, where the jaw turns) and blend down the neck.

Softening the corners rounds the shape. Lining the whole jaw draws it.

3

Nothing on the chin — instead a little concealer or highlighter on the centre of the chin and the centre of the forehead.

Light brings the centre forward, which makes the sides recede.

4

Blush placed high on the cheekbone, blended up toward the temple — not on the apple.

Lifts the face; the apple placement pulls it down after 45.

5

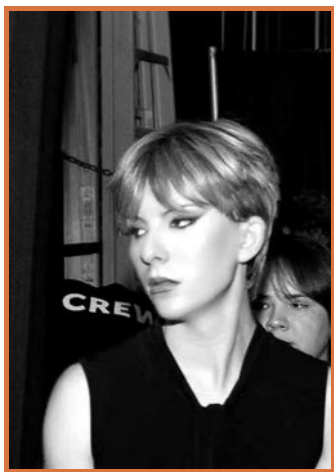
Blend edges with a clean sponge until you can't see where the contour starts.

If you can see it, it's a stripe.

The rule Contour is done when someone would say “you look rested”, not “you’re wearing contour”.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

These five don't solve *your* face



Jake Smith, Semargi stylist

The five fixes solve the most common problems. They don't solve your skin tone, your lid shape, the products already in your bag.

That's what a first session is for: 30 minutes on Zoom with a Semargi stylist, camera on or off, your makeup bag beside you. You leave with your three priorities and one technique that works today.

Your first two sessions — \$59

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Over the next few days we'll send you one email for each fix. If you only read one — read the one about your biggest problem. Reply to the first email with one word and we'll know which one that is.

It stays private. No photos are kept, nothing is ever published, and emails from us never say what they're about.



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